

A marketing *handbook.*

Mantras, formats, and how I think about content.

A short book for marketers, founders, and anyone trying to build work that ages well. Read it in twenty minutes. Keep it on your desk.



Mehr Patni Dubai · 2026 · No. 01

Marketing that *ages well*.

A short opening note before the rest of the book.

Most marketing peaks the day it ships. A campaign goes live, the dashboard lights up, and three months later nobody remembers it ran. The work disappears at the speed of the algorithm.

I'm interested in the opposite. The deposits that compound. The voice that becomes infrastructure. The asset built like a campaign and earning forever after. I call it *marketing that ages well* — work built for the residue, not the peak.

This handbook is the shortest version of what I've learned writing for fintech, healthtech, and edtech brands across four markets. Five qualities that show up in every piece of work I respect. Five formats and the unique job each does. A few mantras I keep close.

It's not exhaustive. It's not academic. It's the kind of small book I'd hand a junior marketer on their first week.

Profit per piece, *not* views per piece.

Mehr Patni mehrpatni.com

The five *qualities*.

Every piece of work I respect carries at least two of these. The best carry four.

i.

Nostalgic

Borrows a feeling from the past to land an idea in the present. Memory is the cheapest emotional bandwidth.

A childhood meal in a fintech campaign. Old typewriter sounds in a productivity ad.

ii.

Emotion-evoking

Names a feeling the audience already has. Not "feel this" but "I felt that too." The work works because it locates them.

Headspace meditation as a permission to be unwell. Calm Sleep Stories as a quiet hand on the shoulder.

iii.

Educational

Leaves you smarter. Trust compounds when you've learned something — even a thirty-second reel can carry one good idea.

A Khan Academy explainer. The Brain Health Playbook. Wahed's plain-English glossary.

iv.

Humour

The permission slip. Audiences let humour in when they would not let advertising in. Used sparingly, it amplifies the rest.

Duolingo's mascot speaking like a chaotic friend. Sub-tweets a serious brand wouldn't dare.

v.

Importance

Makes someone feel the stakes. Most marketing is forgettable because nothing important is happening. The good stuff signals: this matters.

Sal Khan introducing Khanmigo on a TED stage. Founders putting their face on serious decisions.

Pick two before you ship. Pick four to be remembered.

Different formats do *different jobs*.

Pick the format that does the job. Don't force a job into the wrong format.

A reel cannot do what a podcast does. A LinkedIn post cannot do what a YouTube long-form does. The fastest way to waste budget is to pretend they are interchangeable.

The next five pages are a quick handbook to the formats I keep coming back to — what each is uniquely good at, and a tight strategy for actually working in it.



FIG. 01 The format stack. None of these substitute for another. The strongest marketing stacks use four or five in parallel.
Mehr Patni Ch. II · Formats · 004

Newsletter.

Trust · Weekly · Compounding

The highest signal-to-noise channel in your audience's life. Subscribed equals invited. Inbox is sacred.

Why it matters

A *permission* channel.

Algorithms decide who sees a post. The reader decides whether to open a newsletter. That tiny difference is everything — you are arriving as a guest, not as an ad.

The job it does

Long relationship *maintenance*.

Compound trust, one week at a time. The newsletter is where a stranger becomes a reader, a reader becomes a customer, a customer becomes a friend.

My strategy

- One editorial spine. The reader should know what to expect within three issues.
- Same day each week. Cadence is more important than length.
- No growth tactics. The list is the asset; open rate is the symptom.
- Personal voice. If a machine could have written it, don't send it.

Common mistakes

- Treating it as a content recap. Newsletters are essays, not RSS feeds.
- Buying subscribers. The list rots from the inside out.
- Selling on every issue. The third one is the one that hurts.

"The quietest channel earns the *loudest* results."

Mantra · I

Mehr Patni Ch. II · Newsletter · 005

YouTube.

Authority · Evergreen · Searchable

The only format where a single piece can work for a decade. Searchable, evergreen, founder-voice at distribution scale.

Why it matters

A library, not a feed.

Everything on YouTube is still discoverable five years later. That is unique in modern media. A good video pays its production cost back over years.

The job it does

Educational *moat*.

Build the answer to the question your category keeps asking. When the search exists, your video already answers it.

My strategy

- Twelve to twenty minutes. Long enough to teach, short enough to finish.
- Evergreen titles. No trend bait. Write the title someone will search in 2028.
- The thumbnail and title are the entire pitch. The video is the keep.
- One clear thesis per video. If you can't say it in one sentence, split the video.

Common mistakes

- Re-cutting reels and calling it YouTube. The format is different; treat it different.
- Chasing views over saves. Saves are the compounding metric.
- Hiding the founder. The face on the thumbnail is the trust signal.

"Make it the answer to a question someone will *ask in 2028*."

Mantra · II

Mehr Patni Ch. II · YouTube · 006

Podcast.

Intimacy · Slow · Parasocial

An hour of someone's attention is worth fifty posts about you. The podcast is the slowest, deepest channel — and the hardest to fake.

Why it matters

Parasocial *trust* at scale.

The listener spends sixty minutes with your voice in their head — on a run, in a car, washing dishes. No other format earns that proximity.

The job it does

Founder voice as *relationship*.

Two voices in conversation beat one talking head. Long arcs beat clip culture. Slow audience-building at depth no other channel can reach.

My strategy

- Long conversations. Sixty to ninety minutes. The good part is at minute forty-four.
- Don't edit your personality out. The pauses are part of the voice.
- Two voices, not one. A guest sharpens the host.
- Show notes are the search layer. Treat them like SEO copy.

Common mistakes

- Twenty-minute episodes. Either commit to a long form or pick a different format.
- Booking famous guests with thin questions. The questions are the brand.
- Over-producing. Polish erases intimacy.

"An hour *with* you is worth fifty posts *about* you."

Mantra · III

Mehr Patni Ch. II · Podcast · 007

LinkedIn.

Presence · Daily · Decision-makers

The only feed where decision-makers actually browse during the workday. Distribution for the founder voice, at the room where serious business sits.

Why it matters

A boardroom, dressed as a feed.

CMOs read LinkedIn on the way into the meeting. Founders read it in line for coffee. The audience you are trying to reach is already here, scrolling.

The job it does

Founder voice *distributed*.

Daily presence by the founder is the cheapest inbound channel modern marketing has invented. Show up. Have a thesis. Repeat.

My strategy

- Native long-form beats links out. The platform rewards readers, not clickers.
- One thesis per post. No multi-topic carousels stitched together.
- Daily cadence from the founder. Even three sentences. Especially three sentences.
- No growth hacks. Hooks rot the voice. Earn it instead.

Common mistakes

- Outsourcing the founder voice to a ghost-writer with no taste.
- Re-posting press releases. The feed has lower tolerance for those than any other surface.
- Trying to be funny. LinkedIn rewards conviction, not stand-up.

"Your CEO posts to *one* feed. Pick wisely."

Mantra · IV

Mehr Patni Ch. II · LinkedIn · 008

Instagram.

Brand register · Visual · Cultural

Where the brand's register lives. Reels carry feeling, carousels carry ideas — and together they make a magazine.

Why it matters

A *visual* brand stack.

Instagram is where a stranger forms an opinion about how your brand *looks* before they know what it does. The grid is the brand cover.

The job it does

Top of funnel · social *proof*.

Brand recall at the surface, cultural fluency at the back. Use reels for energy, carousels for education, Stories for proof. Each does a different job.

My strategy

- Reels = energy. Three seconds in, the audience should feel a register shift.
- Carousels = ideas. Treat each slide like a page of a book — design for swiping.
- Stories = proof. Where the messy real-time stuff lives.
- The grid is the brand cover. Design for the third-tile reveal, not the single post.

Common mistakes

- Cross-posting LinkedIn into Instagram. The audience is in a different mode.
- Treating reels like ads. They get scrolled. Treat them like editorial.
- Inconsistent grid covers. Visual whiplash kills the brand register.

"Reels make people *feel*. Carousels make people *think*."

Mantra · V

Mehr Patni Ch. II · Instagram · 009

Keep these *close*.

Ten lines I return to before I write anything. Print this page. Tape it above the desk.

- i.
Profit per piece, *not* views per piece.
 - ii.
Boring beats viral when it *compounds*.
 - iii.
The deposits are the work. The withdrawal is the *campaign*.
 - iv.
Voice eats first. Tactics are the *garnish*.
 - v.
When everyone has the same machine — the *taste* behind it is the brand.
 - vi.
The quietest channel earns the *loudest* results.
 - vii.
Make it the answer to a question someone will *ask in 2028*.
 - viii.
An hour *with* you is worth fifty posts *about* you.
 - ix.
Reels make people *feel*. Carousels make people *think*.
 - x.
Pick two qualities before you ship. Pick four to be *remembered*.
- Mehr Patni Coda · 010 · End of book